

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Chicken Paella

with Peppers, Spinach, and Castelvetrano Olives

Tonight, we're bringing a classic Spanish dish to the dinner table. Ground chicken is browned in a paella spice blend, which includes traditional seasonings like turmeric, paprika, and saffron. Sautéed bell pepper, tomatoes, and spinach are stirred in, along with short-grain Arborio rice; then, it's all crisped up in a hot pan. This crunchy, caramelized bottom layer is known as *socarrat*—and it's one of our favorite parts of the dish.

30–40 minutes 710 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1 cup Arborio rice
- 1 chicken bouillon cube
- 1 tablespoon paella spice mix
- 1½ pounds ground chicken
- 3 ounces baby spinach
- 1 red bell pepper
- 3 plum tomatoes
- ¼ cup Castelvetrano olives
- 2 shallots
- 1 lemon

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
6" small pot with lid
12" large nonstick pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Short-grain Arborio rice helps us achieve a classic paella texture here—it has a slightly firmer texture and doesn't stick together as much as other types of rice. This also helps the base get extra crispy in Step 5.

Cooking with a helper tonight? Have them **rinse the produce** in Step 3, **stir the chicken and vegetable mixture** in Step 4, and **arrange the olives** in Step 5.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Cook rice

In a small pot, combine **Arborio rice** (see recipe tip), **bouillon cube**, **half of spice mix**, **1½ cups water**, and **½ teaspoon salt**; bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Fluff **rice** with a fork, then set aside uncovered to release steam, making it easier to crisp in Step 5.



2. Cook chicken

While rice cooks, heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a large nonstick pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken**; season with **remaining spice mix**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired. Cook, breaking up meat, until browned, about 5 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **chicken** to a large bowl. Wipe pan clean and reserve, off heat, for Step 4.



3. Prepare ingredients

While chicken cooks, rinse all produce. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel and roughly chop. Halve **bell pepper** lengthwise, discarding seeds and stem; cut lengthwise into ¼-inch strips, then halve crosswise. Finely chop **tomatoes**. Halve **olives**. Peel **shallots**, halve, and thinly slice.



4. Sauté vegetables

Return pan from chicken to medium-high heat with **1 tablespoon olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **bell pepper** and **shallots**; sauté, stirring, until softened, 4–5 minutes. Add **tomatoes** and sauté, stirring, until tender, 2–3 minutes more. Transfer **vegetables** to bowl with chicken, reserving pan for the next step. Add **spinach**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** to bowl with chicken; stir to combine and wilt spinach slightly.



5. Finish paella

Return pan from vegetables to medium-high heat with **2½ tablespoons olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add cooked **rice** and **chicken and vegetables**; stir to combine, then press down into a single layer. Cook, without moving, until crisp and golden on bottom, 5–6 minutes. Meanwhile, arrange **olives** cut-side down on top of paella in a single layer—feel free to get creative with the design. Cut **lemon** into wedges for serving.



6. Plate chicken paella

Transfer **chicken paella** to serving plates, or serve family-style, straight from the pan. Enjoy with **lemon wedges** for squeezing over. Dig in!

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